

having the inherited font colour, but it should not be assumed that it has the same background colour.

2.5 Contextual selectors

In the previous section, we used emphasised text in a heading and illustrated basic inheritance. The `em` selector was added to ensure the `<em>` element in the HTML would be rendered with red text. Let's use the same CSS code again:

```
/* Top-level heading */
h1 {
  color:#333;
}
/* Make emphasized text shine brightly */
em {
  color:#F00;
}
```

The downside of this is that all emphasized text across the whole web site would also become red, regardless of its parent element. Assuming the rule is only meant to target the `<em>` element when a child of `<h1>` headings, a simple adjustment can be made to put the emphasized text into context:

```
/* Make emphasised text shine brightly ONLY in an h1
heading */
h1 em {
  color:#F00;
}
```

Contextual selectors are basically two or more simple selectors separated by whitespace. We construct a contextual selector to show that the rule will only have an effect when the last selector (`em`) is a direct descendent (be it a child, grandchild, great grandchild, or so on) of the first selector (`h1`).

`<h1>This is the best heading <em>in the world</em></h1>`
`<p>I'm sorry but it simply is <em>not</em>, you fool.</p>`
The `<em>` element owned by the `<h1>` element will be red, whereas the one owned by the paragraph will not.

2.6 CSS measurements

One of the properties of a CSS-based design is its ability to be very flexible. As a designer, you would want your carefully designed layouts to look exactly the way you imagined it across all platforms and for every end user.